

Source: domain.com.au/news/first-home-buyers-using-house-sitting-to-save-deposits-20160226-gn3dco/

Beware: the savings you make can be offset by unusual responsibilities. Another house-sitter who *Domain* talked to, charged with minding a semi-rural property, braved some ugly and unwelcome house guests:

We had a massive invasion of huntsmen one night just before a storm. I think we killed 12 in a row. We were not accustomed to managing what might seem to semi-rural people like ordinary household issues. I mean, what do you do when you get home from work and someone's horse is in your driveway?

Source: domain.com.au/news/house-sitting-will-save-you-money-but-be-prepared-for-awkward-situations20170710-gx653f/

Of about 800 Australian house-sitters polled by the house-and pet-sitting website Mindahome, a fifth were doing so to save for a property, and more than a third were aged 18 to 35. Hooking up with a homeowner works a lot like a dating app; win their heart with your application, and win the keys. For a fee – one-off or charged monthly, depending on the brokering website – you register and fill out a profile; having references will help, just like for a job pitch. Homeowners can contact you, or you can message them if they live in a suburb or town that allows for an easy commute to your work and other day-to-day commitments. As part of the official process, you will likely need to submit to a police check.

Pros

- Rent-free living
- Based on the level of trust between you and the homeowner, you may not even have to pay a bond
- Pump the bulk of your salary towards a first home deposit and savings
- Independence and your own space
- The freedom of simplifying your life to the few belongings that you tote from property to property
- Exploring new neighbourhoods and towns. A house-sitting appointment could last a few days to a year, and doubles as a